

ECON 2P03: Economics of Professional Sports

Summer 2026

Instructor Information

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Office hours: Posted on Avenue to Learn (A2L)

Notice

Please note that the terms and conditions contained in the course syllabus as listed below are not negotiable under any circumstances. Your continued enrollment in the course beyond the final registration date of Monday July 13, 2026 constitutes your explicit acceptance of all terms and conditions listed in this syllabus and your explicit agreement to abide by all such terms. Your continued enrollment in the course furthermore constitutes your explicit acceptance and agreement to abide by all university policies whether listed or not listed in this syllabus.

Course Information

Lectures: see Avenue to Learn (A2L) or MOSAIC for times and classroom information

Labs: No

Tutorials: No

Course Dates: 2026/06/29- 2026/08/14

Units: 3.0

Course Delivery Mode: Online

Course Description: This course covers the application of economic principles to team and individual professional sports including: theory of sports leagues, demand for sports, the market for athletes, broadcasting rights, competition policy issues, the public finance aspects of stadium financing.

Please note that students are expected to be familiar with major North American sports leagues, teams and their basic rules for play. This knowledge will be assumed and is not formally taught in the course. For an overview of league rules, please refer to the following information:

MLB: <https://mktg.mlbstatic.com/mlb/official-information/2024-official-baseball-rules.pdf>

NBA: <https://official.nba.com/rulebook/>

NFL: <https://operations.nfl.com/the-rules/nfl-rulebook/>

NHL: <https://media.nhl.com/site/asset/public/ext/2024-25/2024-25Rules.pdf>

Rules for other sports discussed in the course can be found from their respective leagues or sport governing bodies.

Meeting Details

The course is delivered using an online-learning format. Each week, you will complete a series of lessons provided on Avenue in video format at a time which is convenient for you. You will also have a series of readings from the course textbook to complete independently.

Throughout the course, you will be asked to demonstrate your learning by completing regular term tests. Please be sure to use a weekly schedule to stay on track with the assigned readings, videos, and tests throughout the semester!

Important Links

- [Mosaic](#)
- [Avenue to Learn](#)
- [Student Accessibility Services - Accommodations](#)
- [McMaster University Library](#)
- [eReserves](#)
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Course Learning Outcomes

By the end of the course students should be able to:

- Discuss how economic principles relate to professional sports
- Identify evidence of economic principles in the business operations of professional sports
- Analyze professional sports markets using basic economic principles

Materials and Fees

- **Textbook (Required)**

Berri, David. (2018). *Principles of Sports Economics*, New York, NY: Macmillan Learning.

Students are provided with a redemption code for a 6-month subscription to the textbook at the discounted price of \$59.95 from the Campus Bookstore. The redemption code is provided by email from the Bookstore. Should you experience difficulties or do not receive your code with 3 days of the start of the term or your enrollment in the course, whichever is later, please contact the Bookstore for assistance.

Should you not wish to purchase the book through the bookstore, please follow the instructions to opt out of the Bookstore purchase program contained in the email you receive from the bookstore or contact OptOut@mcmaster.ca.

Alternatively, students can purchase either a 6-month subscription or a lifetime subscription to the textbook directly from the publisher here:

<https://store.macmillanlearning.com/ca/product/Sports-Economics/p/1319282210>

- **Textbooks (Optional)**

Students who have not previously taken ECON 1BB3: Introductory Macroeconomics will also need to read the following book which is available for free. This book will also provide a review of Introductory Microeconomics content which you will already be familiar with:

Greenlaw et al. (2022), *Principles of Economics*, 3rd Edition.

Available **for free** from:

<https://openstax.org/details/books/principles-economics-3e>

Students who have not previously taken a statistics course should also read the following book which is available for free:

Illowsky et al. (2026). *Introductory Statistics*, 2nd Edition

Available **for free** from:

<https://openstax.org/details/books/introductory-statistics-2e>

- **Calculator (Required)**

A calculator is required for the course. Any scientific calculator model is acceptable.

- **Computer and Internet Connection (Required)**

A working computer and internet connection is required to complete all aspects of the course.

- **Respondus Lockdown Browser (Required)**

The Respondus Lockdown Browser is required. The software is available for free from within Avenue. Students will be directed to the software when they load each test.

Course Evaluation

1. Syllabus Quiz – 0%, Complete it as soon as possible
2. Weekly Term Tests – 100%, Weekly Due Dates (refer to schedule below)

Course Evaluation Details

Syllabus Quiz (0%)

There is one Syllabus Quiz available on Avenue. The Syllabus Quiz contains 10 multiple choice questions about the contents of this course syllabus. Please be sure to read the complete syllabus thoroughly before completing the Syllabus Quiz. **You must score 100% on the Syllabus Quiz to unlock the lesson videos and lecture notes for the term.** You can attempt the Syllabus Quiz as many times as is necessary to obtain 100%.

Tests (100%)

There are six term tests, beginning in Week 2 (see the schedule on pages 12 and 13).

Term Test #1 – Unit 1

Term Test #2 – Units 1 and 2

Term Test #3 – Units 1, 2, and 3

Term Test #4 – Units 1, 2, 3, and 4

Term Test #5 – Units 1, 2, 3, 4, and 5

Term Test #6 – Units 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, and 6

Term Tests are cumulative throughout the term. However, please note that questions do not repeat from one test to another, so, for example, any questions you see on Term Test 1 will not show up again on any future tests. Your lowest test score will be dropped. The remaining five test scores will be worth 20% each. **Term Tests cover material from the lesson videos and assigned readings.**

The tests will consist of 20 multiple choice and/or fill-in-the-blank questions (worth one point each). There is a 35-minute time limit for each test. You may or may not see a “countdown clock” during the test, depending on your browser choice and/or computer settings. Because you are taking the test on your own, we cannot invigilate the same way that we invigilate in-person tests. This means that **you can use your notes and textbook during the test**. You are expected to complete this test without the aid of other students. **Tests will be held on Wednesdays and will be available from 7:00 PM EDT until 9:00 PM EDT only.**

The tests require the use of Respondus Lockdown Browser. The Lockdown Browser prevents you from accessing other websites during the test. To access the Respondus Browser, go the “Quizzes” page on Avenue and start the test. You will be prompted to activate the Lockdown Browser before the test begins.

Test Grade Posting and Test Review

Your grade for each test will be released on Avenue after the test results have been manually reviewed by the instructional team. For tests that include fill-in-the-blank / typed responses, note that this process may take several days.

If you wish to review your test results and seek guidance on improvement, you may do so during any of the scheduled office hours posted on Avenue, just like you would during the Fall or Winter semesters. Office hours in summer term are online only through the Zoom platform using the link posted on Avenue. Please note that to review your test results, you must turn your camera on and you must present your student card or other photo ID before a member of the instructional team shows you your test.

To ensure your success on the tests, please do the following:

- Close all other apps/programs/browser windows.
- Carefully read all instructions before beginning the test. The assigned time limit does not begin until you click the "start quiz" button on Avenue.
- You will see one question at a time, and you cannot move back and forth between questions.
- Once you have chosen your answer click "next question". Do **not** click "next question" more than once. Clicking more than once may result in the pop-up getting stuck and impeding your ability to read future questions. You will not be given any consideration should you make this mistake.

- When you have answered all test questions, click the "submit quiz" at the bottom of the screen. You must submit the test for it to be graded. Do **not** click "submit quiz" until you have answered all questions.
- If you miss the term test, complete the online MSAF form. The rewrite will be Monday during the following week from 7:00 PM EDT to 9:00 PM EDT (5 days after the original test date), except for Monday August 3 where the rewrite will instead take place on Tuesday August 4.
- In the rare event that you should experience a technical problem, exit the test, and relaunch it. The clock will continue to run. **If you begin a test, you cannot submit an MSAF** for that test.
- The “drop lowest score” policy is meant to be insurance against: (1) computer technical problems; (2) internet service provider issues; (3) you mistakenly submit the entire test after completing only a few questions; (4) any other event that causes you to have a started, but incomplete test. If you miss a test completely, your first course of action should be to submit the MSAF and take the rewrite. If you rely on this “drop lowest score” policy for a missed test, and then later in the course you experience technical difficulties, or submission mistakes, you will **not** be given any special consideration.

Grading Scale

Grading Scale

Grade	Equivalent Grade Point	Equivalent Percentages
A+	12	90-100
A	11	85-89.99
A-	10	80-84.99
B+	9	77-79.99
B	8	73-76.99
B-	7	70-72.99
C+	6	67-69.99
C	5	63-66.99
C-	4	60-62.99
D+	3	57-59.99
D	2	53-56.99
D-	1	50-52.99
F	0	0-49.99

Course Schedule

Week 1 (June 29 - July 3)

Unit 1: Introduction to Sports Economics

Readings:

Berri Chapter 1

Greenlaw et al., Chapter 1; Section 2.1 ; Chapter 3; Sections 7.1 – 7.3; Sections 19.1, 19.2

Illowsky et al. Chapter 2

Week 2 (July 6 - July 10)

Unit 2: Revenues and Profits in Professional Sports

Readings:

Berri Chapter 2, Chapter 3

Greenlaw et al., Sections 8.1, 8.2, 9.2, 10.1

TERM TEST 1 - JULY 8 (Unit 1)

Week 3 (July 13 - 17)

Unit 3: Competitive Balance

Readings:

Berri Chapter 4

TERM TEST 2 - JULY 15 (Units 1 and 2)

Week 4 (July 20 - 24)

Unit 4: Collective Bargaining

Readings:

Berri Chapter 5

Greenlaw et al. Section 14.1, 14.2, 14.3, 14.4

TERM TEST 3 - JULY 22 (Units 1, 2, and 3)**Week 5 (July 27 - 31)**

Unit 5: Valuing Players

Readings:

Berri Chapter 6

Greenlaw et al. Section 15.4

TERM TEST 4 - JULY 29 (Units 1, 2, 3, and 4)**Week 6 (August 4 - August 7)**

Unit 6: Sports and the Public Sector

Readings:

Berri Chapter 10

TERM TEST 5 - August 5 (Units 1, 2, 3, 4, and 5)**Week 7 (August 10 - 14)**

No further unit lessons.

TERM TEST 6 - AUGUST 12 (Units 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, and 6)

Late Assignments

Term tests must be completed on their assigned due date during the prescribed availability window. If you miss a Test, you can submit an MSAF to receive a new due date.

Absences, Missed Work or Illness

Students may submit a McMaster Student Absence Form (Self-Report) or a McMaster Student Absence Form (Administrative Report) and request relief from assessed work according to the following:

MSAF (Self Report) requests for relief are for missed academic work worth less than 25% of the final grade resulting from medical or personal situations lasting up to three (3) calendar days. Students shall use the MOSAIC MSAF tool to make MSAF (Self-Report) requests, which:

- a) may only be submitted once per term;
- b) must be submitted within 24 hours of the end of the three (3) day period, and failure to do so may negate the opportunity for relief;
- c) applies only to work due within the period for which the request applies, i.e., the three-day period specified in the MSAF; however, all work due in that period can be covered by one request; and
- d) where applicable, students must provide documentation proving they have not attempted the work if they submit a request for relief.

In the event that a student's MSAF (Self-Report) is accepted, the following relief will be provided:

- 1) Term Test – You will be allowed to write a deferred test on the Monday following the original test date, except for Monday August 3 where the rewrite will instead take place on Tuesday August 4. The deferred test will take place between 7PM EDT and 9PM EDT.

For absences that exceed three (3) calendar days, students must request a MSAF (Administrative Report). Students must contact their Faculty/Program Office to report their absence within 24 hours after returning to their academic activities. Failure to contact and report an absence promptly will negate the opportunity for relief. Students may or may not require an appointment to process the request and will be contacted by the Faculty/Program Office within normal business hours. Where applicable, students must provide documentation proving they have not attempted the work if they submit a request for relief.

In the event that a student's MSAF (Administrative Report) is accepted, the following relief will be provided:

- 1) Term Test – If your absence is for three calendar days or less, you will be allowed to write a deferred test on the Monday following the original test date, except for Monday August 3 where the rewrite will instead take place on Tuesday August 4. The deferred test will take place between 7PM EDT and 9PM EDT. If your absence is for more than three calendar days, please contact the instructor to discuss your return date and an alternative testing date. Note that the final date that a deferred test may be offered is Monday August 17; any uncompleted tests not written by this date will receive a grade of Zero.

Turnitin.com

Some courses may use a web-based service (Turnitin.com) to reveal authenticity and ownership of student submitted work. For students using such software, students will be expected to submit their work electronically either directly to Turnitin.com or via an online learning platform (e.g. A2L, etc.) using plagiarism detection (a service supported by Turnitin.com) so it can be checked for academic dishonesty.

Students who do not wish their work to be submitted through the plagiarism detection software must inform the Instructor before the assignment is due. No penalty will be assigned to a student who does not submit work to the plagiarism detection software. All submitted work is subject to normal verification that standards of academic integrity have been upheld (e.g., on-line search, other software, etc.). For more details about McMaster's use of Turnitin.com please go to www.mcmaster.ca/academicintegrity.

Course Modification

The instructor and university reserve the right to modify elements of the course during the term. The university may change the dates and deadlines for any or all courses in extreme circumstances. If either type of modification becomes necessary, reasonable notice and communication with the students will be given with an explanation and the opportunity to comment on changes. It is the responsibility of the student to check their McMaster email and course websites weekly during the term and to note any changes.

Generative AI

Generative AI: Use Prohibited

Students are not permitted to use generative AI in this course. In alignment with [McMaster academic integrity policy](#), it “shall be an offence knowingly to ... submit academic work for assessment that was purchased or acquired from another source”. This includes work created by generative AI tools. Also state in the policy is the following, “Contract Cheating is the act of “outsourcing of student work to third parties” (Lancaster & Clarke, 2016, p.

639) with or without payment.” Using Generative AI tools is a form of contract cheating. Charges of academic dishonesty will be brought forward to the Office of Academic Integrity.

APPROVED ADVISORY STATEMENTS

Academic Integrity

You are expected to exhibit honesty and use ethical behaviour in all aspects of the learning process. Academic credentials you earn are rooted in principles of honesty and academic integrity. **It is your responsibility to understand what constitutes academic dishonesty.**

Academic dishonesty is to knowingly act or fail to act in a way that results or could result in unearned academic credit or advantage. This behaviour can result in serious consequences, e.g. the grade of zero on an assignment, loss of credit with a notation on the transcript (notation reads: “Grade of F assigned for academic dishonesty”), and/or suspension or expulsion from the university. For information on the various types of academic dishonesty please refer to the [Academic Integrity Policy](https://secretariat.mcmaster.ca/university-policies-proceduresguidelines/), located at <https://secretariat.mcmaster.ca/university-policies-proceduresguidelines/>

The following illustrates only three forms of academic dishonesty:

- plagiarism, e.g. the submission of work that is not one’s own or for which other credit has been obtained.
- improper collaboration in group work.
- copying or using unauthorized aids in tests and examinations.

Authenticity / Plagiarism

Some courses may use a web-based service (Turnitin.com) to reveal authenticity and ownership of student submitted work. For courses using such software, students will be expected to submit their work electronically either directly to Turnitin.com or via an online learning platform (e.g. Avenue to Learn, etc.) using plagiarism detection (a service supported by Turnitin.com) so it can be checked for academic dishonesty.

Students who do not wish their work to be submitted through the plagiarism detection software must inform the Instructor before the assignment is due. No penalty will be assigned to a student who does not submit work to the plagiarism detection software. **All submitted work is subject to normal verification that standards of academic integrity have been upheld** (e.g., on-line search, other software, etc.). For more details about McMaster’s use of Turnitin.com please go to www.mcmaster.ca/academicintegrity.

Email Communication

Effective September 1, 2010, it is the policy of the Faculty of Social Sciences that all e-mail communication sent from students to instructors (including Tasks), and from students to staff, must originate from the student's own McMaster University e-mail account. This policy protects confidentiality and confirms the identity of the student. It is the student's responsibility to ensure that communication is sent to the university from a McMaster account. If an instructor becomes aware that a communication has come from an alternate address, the instructor may not reply at his/her/their discretion.

Courses with an On-line Element

Some courses may use on-line elements (e.g. e-mail, Avenue to Learn, LearnLink, web pages, capa, Moodle, ThinkingCap, etc.). Students should be aware that, when they access the electronic components of a course using these elements, private information such as first and last names, usernames for the McMaster e-mail accounts, and program affiliation may become apparent to all other students in the same course. The available information is dependent on the technology used. Continuation in a course that uses on-line elements will be deemed consent to this disclosure. If you have any questions or concerns about such disclosure, please discuss this with the course instructor.

Online Proctoring

Some courses may use online proctoring software for tests and exams. This software may require students to turn on their video camera, present identification, monitor and record their computer activities, and/or lock/restrict their browser or other applications/software during tests or exams. This software may be required to be installed before the test/exam begins.

Conduct Expectations

As a McMaster student, you have the right to experience, and the responsibility to demonstrate, respectful and dignified interactions within all of our living, learning and working communities. These expectations are described in the [Code of Student Rights & Responsibilities](#) (the "Code"). All students share the responsibility of maintaining a positive environment for the academic and personal growth of all McMaster community members, **whether in person or online.**

It is essential that students be mindful of their interactions online, as the Code remains in effect in virtual learning environments. The Code applies to any interactions that adversely affect, disrupt, or interfere with reasonable participation in University activities. Student disruptions or behaviours that interfere with university functions on online platforms (e.g. use of Avenue 2 Learn, WebEx or Zoom for delivery), will be taken very seriously and will be

investigated. Outcomes may include restriction or removal of the involved students' access to these platforms.

Academic Accommodation of Students with Disabilities

Students with disabilities who require academic accommodation must contact [Student Accessibility Services](#) (SAS) at 905-525-9140 ext. 28652 or sas@mcmaster.ca to make arrangements with a Program Coordinator. For further information, consult McMaster University's [Academic Accommodation of Students with Disabilities](#) policy.

Requests for Relief for Missed Academic Term Work

In the event of an absence for medical or other reasons, students should review and follow the [Policy on Requests for Relief for Missed Academic Term Work](#).

Academic Accommodation for Religious, Indigenous, or Spiritual Observances (RISO)

Students requiring academic accommodation based on religious, indigenous or spiritual observances should follow the procedures set out in the [RISO](#) policy. Students should submit their request to their Faculty Office **normally within 10 working days** of the beginning of term in which they anticipate a need for accommodation or to the Registrar's Office prior to their examinations. Students should also contact their instructors as soon as possible to make alternative arrangements for classes, assignments, and tests.

Copyright and Recording

Students are advised that lectures, demonstrations, performances, and any other course material provided by an instructor include copyright protected works. The Copyright Act and copyright law protect every original literary, dramatic, musical and artistic work, **including lectures** by University instructors.

The recording of lectures, tutorials, or other methods of instruction may occur during a course. Recording may be done by either the instructor for the purpose of authorized distribution, or by a student for the purpose of personal study. Students should be aware that their voice and/or image may be recorded by others during the class. Please speak with the instructor if this is a concern for you.

Extreme Circumstances

The University reserves the right to change the dates and deadlines for any or all courses in extreme circumstances (e.g., severe weather, labour disruptions, etc.). Changes will be communicated through regular McMaster communication channels, such as McMaster Daily News, Avenue to Learn and/or McMaster email.